# MELOXICAM

Once daily

Take with food

**CHEMICAL NAME** 4-hydroxy-2-methyl-N-(5-methyl-1,3-thiazol-2-yl)-2H-1,2-benzothiazine-3-carboxamide 1,1-dioxide

**CLASS** NSAID (oxicam), preferential COX-2 inhibitor

**TRADE NAMES** Mobic · Movalis · Melox

## THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Osteoarthritis (short-term symptom relief of flares).
- Rheumatoid arthritis and ankylosing spondylitis.
- Juvenile idiopathic arthritis.

## ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets once daily with food.
- **IM** injection for short initial treatment in some products.
- **PR** suppositories.

## DOSAGES

- **Osteoarthritis:** 7.5 mg once daily; max 15 mg/day.
- **Rheumatoid arthritis/AS:** 15 mg once daily (7.5 mg in elderly).
- **Dialysis patients:** max 7.5 mg/day.
- **Children ≥2 yr (JIA):** 0.125 mg/kg once daily; max 7.5 mg.

## PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1–2 h. **Peak:** 5–6 h.
- Well absorbed; metabolised in liver (CYP2C9, CYP3A4).
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** about 20 h.

## PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Preferential **COX-2** inhibition at low doses → anti-inflammatory with somewhat less GI toxicity.
- COX-1 inhibition increases at higher doses.

## SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

### SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dyspepsia, nausea, diarrhoea.
- Headache, dizziness.
- Oedema, rash.

### ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- GI bleeding (lower than non-selective NSAIDs but still present).
- Cardiovascular thrombotic events.
- Renal impairment; hyperkalaemia.
- Severe skin reactions.

## CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Active peptic ulcer or recent GI bleed.
- Severe heart, hepatic or renal failure (non-dialysed).
- NSAID-sensitive asthma.
- Third trimester; peri-operative CABG pain.

### KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Anticoagulants, SSRIs:** ↑ bleeding.
- **ACE inhibitors, ARBs, diuretics:** ↑ renal risk, ↓ BP control.
- **Lithium, methotrexate:** ↑ levels.

## NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess GI, CV and renal risk factors.
- Give with food at the same time each day.
- Monitor BP, oedema, renal function in long-term use.
- Assess joint pain and mobility.
- Watch for GI bleeding signs.

## PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take once daily with food.
- Report black stools, chest pain or swelling.
- Avoid other NSAIDs and alcohol.
- Do not exceed the prescribed dose.

## KEY POINTS

- Preferential COX-2 inhibitor; once daily.
- Less GI toxicity, but CV/renal risks remain.
- Max 15 mg/day.
- Used mainly for arthritis.

**SOURCES CHECKED** **[23]** Meloxicam 15 mg Tablets (UK SmPC) **[24]** Meloxicam, oral (US label) **[25]** Qamzova, IV (US label)

*Full references p. 432–457*